INTERMEDIATE PATH

AI Projects, Content & Automation

Turn AI skills into real projects, automated workflows and income: for creators, professionals and business owners.

Course Outline | Session Content | Lab Materials | Assessment

1. Course at a Glance

Item	Details
Duration	4 weeks, 5 days a week, 3 hours per day (60 contact hours) plus unlimited workspace time
Level	Intermediate. Comfortable with ChatGPT-style tools and basic prompting
Class size	12-20 learners, 1 lead trainer + 1 mentor
Format	20% demo, 70% build time, 10% critique and sharing. Every day ends with something that works.
Final result	3 working automations, a content engine, a client-ready AI service offer and a capstone for a real or simulated client

Learning outcomes

- Use advanced prompting: prompt chains, few-shot examples, personas, structured output and self-critique
- Run a repeatable content engine for a brand: research, calendar, copy, graphics, short video scripts
- Build no-code automations connecting Google Sheets, Forms, Gmail and messaging with AI steps
- Analyze business data with AI and present insights as dashboards and short reports
- Create AI customer support and sales assistants that use a business's own information
- Package, price and pitch AI services for local clients and online freelancing platforms

Who it is for and prerequisites

Beginner path graduates, or anyone who already uses AI tools weekly and can write structured prompts. Basic spreadsheet skills required. Learners without the Beginner path take a 90-minute placement test on Day 1 (prompting, safe use, Google Sheets basics). No coding required; logical thinking is enough.

Tools and accounts (all have free tiers)

Tool	Used for
ChatGPT / Gemini / Claude	Advanced prompting, projects, custom assistants, data analysis
Make.com or n8n (cloud free tier) / Zapier	No-code automation with AI steps
Google Sheets, Forms, Gmail, Calendar	Data store, intake forms, notifications
Canva and AI image tools	Brand graphics and carousels
CapCut or similar	Short video editing with AI captions
Notion or Trello	Project management for client work
Looker Studio	Simple dashboards from Google Sheets

Daily session format (3 hours)

Time	Block	What happens
0:00-0:20	Warm-up	Recap, 'show one thing you tried since yesterday', quick quiz
0:20-1:05	Concept + live demo	Instructor demonstrates on the projector; learners follow along
1:05-2:35	Hands-on lab	Individual or pair work on the day's lab, instructor circulates
2:35-3:00	Share-out + homework	2-3 learners demo; exit ticket; next-day challenge

Instructor tip: keep demos under 20 minutes at a time. Learners should have their hands on keyboards for at least 60% of every session. Pair beginners with stronger learners (peer teaching) and keep an 'AI wins' board on the wall.

2. Four-Week Outline

Week	Theme	Weekly deliverable
Week 1	Advanced Prompting and the Content Engine	Prompt playbook (15 prompts), brand voice guide, 2-week content pack
Week 2	Automation and Productivity Systems	3 working automations with documentation
Week 3	AI for Business and Freelancing	Data insight report, customer assistant, service offer and pitch
Week 4	Capstone: Client Project Sprint	Capstone solution, documentation, demo and portfolio

Week 1: Advanced Prompting and the Content Engine

Goal: Get consistent, professional quality from AI and run a repeatable content workflow.

Day 1: Advanced prompting techniques

Concepts:

- Few-shot examples, step by step reasoning, constraints
- Structured output: tables, JSON-like lists, checklists
- Self-critique loops: 'review your answer against this rubric'

Hands-on lab: Take 5 weak real tasks and build high-performance prompts. Run A/B comparison on 2 assistants.

Homework / challenge: Add 3 prompts to your playbook.

Day 2: Prompt chains and brand voice

Concepts:

- Breaking big tasks into chains: research -> outline -> draft -> edit
- Teaching AI a brand voice using sample texts
- Building reusable templates with variables

Hands-on lab: Create a brand voice guide for a business (real client or friend). Test with 3 content types.

Homework / challenge: Collect 5 samples of a brand's real writing.

Day 3: Research and strategy with AI

Concepts:

- Market, audience and competitor research workflow
- Personas and customer pain points
- Verifying facts and citing sources

Hands-on lab: Produce a 2-page strategy brief: audience, offer, 3 content pillars, 5 competitors reviewed.

Homework / challenge: Interview one real customer for 10 minutes.

Day 4: Visual and video content

Concepts:

- Image prompts for brand consistency
- Carousels, banners and thumbnails in Canva
- Short video: script, captions, edits with AI helpers

Hands-on lab: Make 1 carousel, 1 poster and 1 short video (30-45 seconds) for the same brand.

Homework / challenge: Post and measure views for 3 days.

Day 5: Lab day: 2-Week Content Pack

Concepts:

- Batching content and quality checks
- Review checklist: accuracy, tone, call to action

Hands-on lab: Produce a 14-day calendar with finished copy and visuals for 10 posts; peer review using the rubric.

Homework / challenge: Present the pack in 2 minutes.

Week 2: Automation and Productivity Systems

Goal: Connect tools so repetitive work runs by itself, with AI inside the workflow.

Day 6: Automation thinking

Concepts:

- Triggers, actions, filters and data mapping
- Finding automation opportunities: the 'do it 3 times' rule
- Reliability, errors and security basics

Hands-on lab: Process-map a real workflow on paper, then build a simple automation (form -> sheet -> email).

Homework / challenge: Document 5 processes you could automate.

Day 7: AI inside automations

Concepts:

- Calling an AI step with a prompt template
- Classifying, summarizing and drafting inside a workflow
- Human-in-the-loop approvals

Hands-on lab: Build: new customer form -> AI classifies and drafts reply -> manager approves -> email sent.

Homework / challenge: Test with 10 sample entries.

Day 8: Document and data workflows

Concepts:

- Extracting data from emails and PDFs
- Auto-filling Sheets, invoices and reports
- Scheduled reports

Hands-on lab: Build a weekly report generator: Sheet data -> AI summary -> email to the boss.

Homework / challenge: Run it for a week with fake data.

Day 9: Messaging and customer workflows

Concepts:

- WhatsApp Business and Cloud API concepts, quick replies
- Lead capture and follow-up sequences
- Ethics: consent, opt-outs, data protection law awareness

Hands-on lab: Design and simulate a lead follow-up flow; build the Sheet and email parts live.

Homework / challenge: Write the customer consent wording.

Day 10: Lab day: Automation Showcase

Concepts:

- Troubleshooting and monitoring
- Writing simple documentation and handover notes

Hands-on lab: Finalize 3 automations; swap and test each other's work; write a 1-page how-to for each.

Homework / challenge: Prepare a 3-minute demo.

Week 3: AI for Business and Freelancing

Goal: Analyze data, build customer-facing assistants and package services you can sell.

Day 11: Data analysis with AI

Concepts:

- Cleaning messy data and spotting patterns
- Charts and plain-language insights
- Checking AI calculations (never skip verification)

Hands-on lab: Analyze a sample sales dataset: find top products, trends, and 3 recommendations with charts.

Homework / challenge: Find a dataset in your own work or community and analyze.

Day 12: Dashboards and reporting

Concepts:

- Looker Studio basics with Sheets
- KPIs that matter for small business
- Writing executive summaries

Hands-on lab: Create a live dashboard and a one-page management report from one dataset.

Homework / challenge: Share it with a real business owner for feedback.

Day 13: Customer support and sales assistants

Concepts:

- Building an FAQ assistant from a business's documents
- Tone, escalation and 'I don't know' rules
- Testing with tricky questions

Hands-on lab: Build a support assistant for a shop, school or clinic booking use case; run 20 test questions.

Homework / challenge: Collect 10 real FAQs from a local business.

Day 14: Freelancing and service packaging

Concepts:

- Choosing a niche: content, automation, support bots, data help
- Pricing in KES and USD, packages and contracts
- Profiles on Upwork, Fiverr, LinkedIn; proposal writing

Hands-on lab: Create 3 service packages, a portfolio page, a profile and 2 proposals for real job posts.

Homework / challenge: Send 3 real proposals or outreach messages.

Day 15: Lab day: Pitch and Proposal

Concepts:

- Discovery calls and handling objections
- Delivering and invoicing professionally

Hands-on lab: Mock client calls in pairs; refine your offer; record a 90-second pitch.

Homework / challenge: Contact one local business.

Week 4: Capstone: Client Project Sprint

Goal: Deliver a complete, professional AI solution for a real or simulated client.

Day 16: Discovery and project plan

Concepts:

- Client brief, scope, success measures and timeline
- Risk and data protection checklist

Hands-on lab: Choose a client, interview them, produce a 2-page project plan.

Homework / challenge: Confirm plan with client.

Day 17: Build sprint 1

Concepts:

- Prioritizing a minimum viable solution
- Daily stand-up and mentor reviews

Hands-on lab: Build core workflow or content system; hold a mid-day checkpoint.

Homework / challenge: Prepare questions for mentor.

Day 18: Build sprint 2

Concepts:

- Testing, edge cases and error handling
- Writing user instructions

Hands-on lab: Complete the solution; test with real inputs; write a how-to guide.

Homework / challenge: Collect client feedback.

Day 19: Polish and portfolio

Concepts:

- Case study structure: problem, solution, results
- Building a portfolio page

Hands-on lab: Write your case study with screenshots and results; build your portfolio page.

Homework / challenge: Rehearse demo.

Day 20: Demo Day and graduation

Concepts:

- 10-minute demos with Q and A from local business guests
- Next steps: Advanced path and client acquisition

Hands-on lab: Present, receive feedback, and sign up for the next cohort or client opportunities.

Homework / challenge: Deliver the project to your client.

3. Learner Materials Pack

Print these for every learner and keep digital copies in the shared drive. Instructors can copy and adapt freely.

A. Prompt Chain Templates

```
CONTENT CHAIN
1. RESEARCH:  Act as a market researcher for [business, location]. List 10 audience
              pain points and 10 questions customers ask. Table format.
2. STRATEGY:  Using the table above, propose 4 content pillars and 3 hooks each.
3. DRAFT:     Write 7 posts for pillar [X] in the brand voice below. [paste voice guide]
4. CRITIQUE:  Review the posts against this rubric: clear hook, one idea, local
              relevance, call to action. Score each post 1-5 and suggest fixes.
5. FINAL:     Rewrite posts scoring below 4 and give a posting calendar.
```

B. Brand Voice Guide Template

Section	Fill in
Who we serve	Audience description and needs
Tone words	3 words we are and 3 we are not
Vocabulary	Words and phrases to use and to avoid
Sample sentences	5 real examples that sound like us
Never	Claims or topics we avoid

C. Automation Blueprint Worksheet

Field	Description
Name and owner	What it is called and who owns it
Trigger	What starts it (form, new email, schedule)
Inputs	Data needed and where it lives
AI step	Prompt and expected output format
Actions	What happens next (write to Sheet, send email)
Human check	Where a person approves
Failure plan	What happens if it breaks
Success measure	Hours saved per week or errors reduced

D. Service Package Pricing Guide

Package	Typical content	Price guide (adjust to market)
Starter	Brand voice guide and 10 posts	KES 5,000-10,000
Growth	30-day content engine with graphics	KES 15,000-30,000 per month
Automation	1 workflow built, tested, documented	KES 10,000-40,000
Support bot	FAQ assistant with training and handover	KES 20,000-60,000

Prices are illustrative; research local rates and charge for value and maintenance, not hours alone.

E. Client Delivery Checklist

- Written scope signed by both sides
- Data protection and consent confirmed
- Tested with at least 20 real examples
- User guide and short training for client staff
- Handover meeting and 14-day support promise

4. Capstone Project

Each learner (or pair) delivers a complete solution for a real client such as a shop, school, clinic, church, farm group or online business. If no client is available, use a simulated brief from the trainer.

Minimum requirements

- A written brief and plan agreed with the client
- One content system OR one automation OR one customer assistant, working end to end
- Documentation and a user guide
- A case study with measurable results
- A 10-minute demo and a portfolio page

5. Assessment and Certification

Component	Weight	What we look for
Attendance and participation	15%	Present, collaborating, giving useful peer feedback
Weekly builds	35%	Working deliverables each week
Business thinking	15%	Client understanding, pricing and offer clarity
Quality and safety	10%	Testing, data protection, human checks
Capstone and demo	25%	Client value, polish and communication

Certificate of Completion: 80% attendance and a delivered capstone. Distinction: 85% overall and client testimonial or measurable result.